

CHINA · FEATURED DEPARTURES

Kiwi journeys to China 2026 → 2027

11 confirmed small-group departures across late 2026 and 2027, plus 14 short China stopovers. Escorted from New Zealand. Tours priced from NZ\$3,399pp; stopovers from NZ\$875pp.



A WORD FROM CTS TOURS

The Kiwi China specialist.

CTS Tours New Zealand was established in Auckland in 2000 by Lisa Li, MNZM — the New Zealand arm of the China Travel Service Group, founded in 1928. 25 years on we look after 1,200+ Kiwi travellers to China every year. We design and operate every China holiday package in-house, with our own ground operations in China rather than reselling a third party's tour.

GLOBAL HERITAGE

1928

CTS parent network
operating in China since
1928

YEARS IN AUCKLAND

25

Kiwi-led NZ operations
since 2000

TRAVELLERS A YEAR

1,200+

Kiwi travellers to China

GOOGLE RATING

4.4★

12 verified reviews ·
checked 22 September
2026

REAL WORDS FROM CTS TRAVELLERS

“The china journey was well-organized, I actually enjoyed all the moments without worrying about anything. Highly recommend the tour of tale of two cities china”

MARYAM ABSH · TALE OF TWO CITIES · JULY 2026

“Just came back from a tour of Xinjiang and a stopover in Xian. We had a fantastic time, the culture and scenery in Xinjiang is stunning and the tour was led by an experienced guide with excellent English. Highly recommended.”

MURRAY MIDDENDORF · XINJIANG · JUNE 2026

Every review above is public on the CTS Tours Google Business profile and quoted word for word.

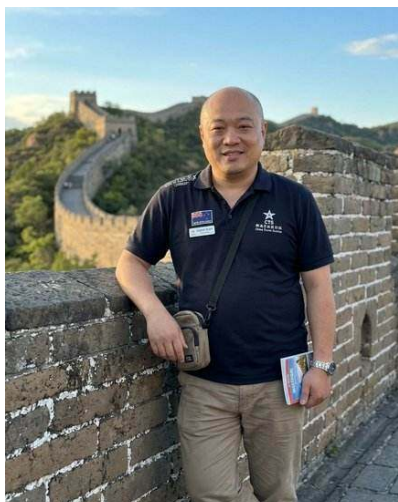
GROUP SIZE

- **China Discovery — max 18 travellers.** A genuine small group, not a 30-plus coach tour.
- **China Signature — max 16 travellers.**

ACCREDITED & BONDED

- TAANZ member — client funds held in a TAANZ-bonded trust account
- IATA-accredited
- Recognised by Qualmark
- Member of the Tourism Export Council of New Zealand
- Member of Tourism Industry Aotearoa
- Member of the Auckland Business Chamber

Welcome — let me plan your **China trip.**



YOUR CHINA SPECIALIST

Baker Gu

China Travel Specialist · 20+ years

I've spent over 20 years designing premium China tours — from Beijing's Forbidden City and Shanghai's Bund to the Silk Road and the karst country around Guilin. Every tour in this brochure I've personally helped shape.

When you call CTS, you'll speak to a real China specialist — most likely me. No call centres, no overseas hand-off. Just honest advice from someone who has spent two decades designing China trips for Kiwi travellers.

Eleven departures is a lot to choose between. Give me a call on **0800 CTS 888** and I'll give you a no-pressure recommendation based on your dates, your pace, and what you most want to see.

CALL

0800 CTS 888

0800 287 888

EMAIL

info@ctstours.co.nz

Same-day reply Mon–Fri

VISIT

2F CTS House

175 Queen Street, Auckland
CBD

ONLINE

ctstours.co.nz

24/7 enquiry form

WHY CHINA · WHY NOW

The window is open.

New Zealand passport holders can walk straight through Chinese immigration — no visa, no forms, no queue at the embassy. **The current policy runs through 31 December 2026.**

CURRENT POLICY

30 days visa-free

For NZ passport holders, valid through 31 December 2026.

WHAT'S COVERED

Tourism, business, family visits and transit. Unlimited entries. No application forms needed.

WHAT TO BRING

NZ passport with blank pages, return flight, and proof of accommodation — your CTS tour confirmation is enough.

Travelling in 2027? Read this one line.

The visa-free arrangement published on our website is valid **through 31 December 2026**. Every 2027 departure in this brochure sits beyond that date, and **entry requirements for 2027 travel will be whatever policy applies at the time you travel** — not what is printed here. We track this for every booked traveller and will tell you well before departure if a visa becomes necessary. CTS provides full visa assistance either way, so a policy change does not put your trip at risk.

BEST TIME TO TRAVEL

Autumn (September–October) and spring (April–May) both give you cool, clear days across northern China. November stays crisp and quiet; March is when Hangzhou's West Lake starts to bloom; late May opens up the Silk Road and the Tibetan plateau. Every departure in this brochure sits in one of those two windows.



Five cities, five Chinas.

Every CTS itinerary weaves together several very different Chinas. Here's how to think about the ones you'll actually walk through.



01

Beijing 北京

An unparalleled gateway to Chinese civilisation — imperial grandeur that feels planned for you, contemporary energy that just happens. The Forbidden City is the world's largest imperial palace complex.

SEE → **FORBIDDEN CITY · GREAT WALL · TEMPLE OF HEAVEN**



02

Xi'an 西安

Capital of thirteen dynasties, and the eastern end of the Silk Road. The star turn is the Terracotta Army. The city walls are still walkable end to end.

SEE → **TERRACOTTA ARMY · CITY WALL · MUSLIM QUARTER**



03

Shanghai 上海

Asia's most cosmopolitan city — skyscrapers alongside a colonial waterfront, upscale dining next to laneway cafés. The Bund's evening light show still stops people in their tracks.

SEE → **THE BUND · YU GARDEN · NANJING ROAD**

CONTINUED OVERLEAF

Hangzhou and Chongqing — the two cities Kiwis quietly rave about back home — plus the landscapes the 2027 Signature journeys reach.

Beyond the big **three**.

Two cities that turn a China trip into something Kiwis quietly rave about back home — and, new for 2027, the landscapes further out.



04

Hangzhou 杭州

A landscape aestheticised by human hands for a thousand years. Walking the Su Causeway around West Lake before the crowds is a Chinese poem you get to stand inside.

SEE → WEST LAKE · SU CAUSEWAY · LONGJING TEA VILLAGE



05

Chongqing 重庆

A vertical mountain city that stacks streets and skyscrapers across so many levels that GPS gives up. The signature draw is a Chongqing hotpot — bolder, more molten málà than Chengdu next door.

SEE → HONGYADONG · CIIQIKOU OLD TOWN · LIZIBA MONORAIL

NEW IN THE 2027 PROGRAMME

Four Signature journeys reach well past the classic five: **Guilin, Yangshuo and Zhangjiajie** for karst and sandstone country; **Dali and Kunming** in Yunnan; **Lhasa** and the Potala Palace; the **Three Gorges** by river cruise; and the whole Silk Road corridor west from Xi'an to **Dunhuang, Turpan and Urumqi**.

Four ways to travel with CTS.

Eleven escorted departures, fourteen short stopovers, and a tailor-made desk if none of them is quite your trip. Here is the quickest way to narrow it down.

PAGES 8–19 · 6 DEPARTURES

China Discovery

The classic routes, 10 to 16 days, four-star hotels, maximum 18 travellers. This is where most first trips to China start. From **NZ\$3,399pp**.

PAGES 20–26 · 4 DEPARTURES

China Signature

Longer and further — 16 to 27 days, four and five-star hotels, river cruises, first-class rail, maximum 16 travellers. From **NZ\$7,999pp**.

PAGE 29 · 14 ROUTES

China Stopover

Two to five days in one Chinese city, built to slot into a flight you are already taking to Europe, Japan or Korea. From **NZ\$875pp**, land package.

PAGE 30

Tailor-made

Your dates, your pace, your interests. A specialist shapes the route with you before anything is booked. No obligation.

Still deciding? Start with the date, not the itinerary.

If you want to go this year, there are three departures left — Golden China in November and the two Christmas groups in December. If you are planning ahead, March 2027 is spring in the north and has four departures; May 2027 is the long-journey window, when the Silk Road, Tibet and Yunnan open up. Turn to pages 27–28 to compare them side by side.

DEPARTURE 01 · CHINA DISCOVERY

Golden China

12 days · Departs **Auckland 16 Nov 2026** · Returns **27 Nov 2026**

Beijing · Xi'an · Shanghai

FROM

NZ\$4,999

per person, twin share

GROUP SIZE

Max 18

escorted from New Zealand

MEALS

26 included

9 B · 7 L · 10 D

HOTELS

4★

9 nights across 3 properties

DAY BY DAY

- 1 Depart Auckland MU780 22:00
- 2 Arrive Shanghai · connect Beijing · Temple of Heaven · Qianmen Street · Beijing Duck dinner
- 3 Tiananmen Square · Forbidden City · Beihai Park
- 4 Great Wall at Juyongguan · Olympic Park
- 5 Hutong pedi-cab tour with family visit · Summer Palace
- 6 Free morning · train G655 to Xi'an (08:26–14:20)
- 7 Terracotta Warriors · Bronze Chariot · dumpling dinner with Tang Dynasty performances
- 8 Old City Wall · Big Wild Goose Pagoda · fly to Shanghai
- 9 Zhujiajiao water town · Huangpu River evening cruise
- 10 Yu Garden · Shanghai Museum · The Bund · Nanjing Road
- 11 Free time · Xintiandi · Tianzifang · depart 00:10
- 12 Arrive Auckland 16:25

FULLY INCLUDED

- International & domestic flights
- 4-star accommodation (9 nights)
- Meals per itinerary
- English-speaking guide
- Land transportation and admission fees
- 2nd-class high-speed train Beijing → Xi'an

NOT INCLUDED

- Travel insurance
- Personal expenses
- Meals not listed · transport during free time
- Tips (suggested NZ\$10 pp/day)

Single supplement NZ\$690 · solo total NZ\$5,689

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/discovery/golden-china

Golden China

Beijing · Xi'an · Shanghai



DEPARTURE 02 · CHINA DISCOVERY

Christmas & New Year in China

16 days · Departs **Auckland 22 Dec 2026** · Returns **6 Jan 2027**

Shanghai · Beijing · Xi'an · Chongqing · Guangzhou

FROM

NZ\$7,188

per person, twin share

GROUP SIZE

Max 18

escorted from New Zealand

MEALS

33 included

12 B · 9 L · 12 D

HOTELS

4★

13 nights across 5 properties

HIGHLIGHTS ACROSS 16 DAYS

- 1 Christmas Eve in Shanghai — the Xintiandi Shikumen Christmas lighting ceremony
- 2 Bund Source German Christmas Market — European wooden stalls, mulled wine, gingerbread, double-decker carousel
- 3 Christmas morning in Zhujiajiao, an ancient water town on Shanghai's outskirts
- 4 **Morning tour to the Great Wall at the Mutianyu section**
- 5 Forbidden City · Tian'anmen Square · Summer Palace
- 6 Beijing hutong pedi-cab tour and Beijing Duck welcome banquet
- 7 New Year's Eve at Xi'an's Tang Dynasty Ever-Bright City — performances, float parades and festive crowds
- 8 Terracotta Warriors with Circle Vision Movie and Bronze Chariot · Xi'an City Wall
- 9 Chongqing — Ciqikou · Liziba · Kuixing Tower · Jiefangbei · Eye in the Clouds
- 10 Cantonese Yum Cha finale in Guangzhou

FULLY INCLUDED

- International and domestic airfares
- 4-star accommodation (13 nights)
- Specified meals
- Private airport transfers and sightseeing transport
- English-speaking local guides
- Entrance fees · 2nd-class train tickets · NYE event

NOT INCLUDED

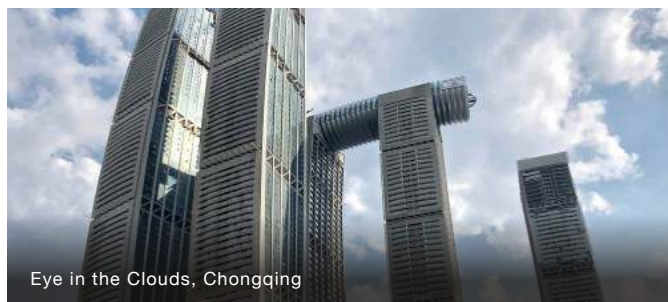
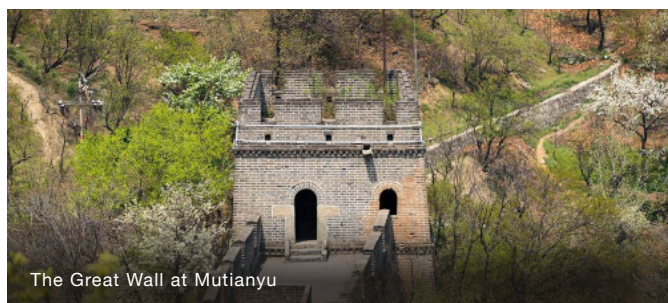
- China visa (if applicable)
- Travel insurance
- Personal expenses
- Tips (suggested NZ\$10 pp/day)

Single supplement NZ\$968 · reserve well ahead — this departure fills earliest

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/discovery/china-icons-collection

Christmas & New Year in China

Shanghai · Beijing · Xi'an · Chongqing · Guangzhou



DEPARTURE 03 · CHINA DISCOVERY

Christmas & New Year — Christchurch

15 days · Departs **Christchurch 22 Dec 2026** · Returns **5 Jan 2027**

Christchurch · Guangzhou · Shanghai · Beijing · Xi'an · Chongqing

FROM

NZ\$6,188

per person, twin share

GROUP SIZE

Max 18

escorted from New Zealand

MEALS

33 included

12 B · 9 L · 12 D

HOTELS

4★

12 nights across 4 properties

WHY THE CHRISTCHURCH VERSION

- A direct South Island departure — fly ex-Christchurch via Guangzhou, no Auckland transfer required.**
- CZ618 Christchurch–Guangzhou, 22:30/05:20+1. This direct service resumed post-pandemic, operated by China Southern Airlines — celebrating its 70th anniversary in 2026.
- Same Christmas Eve in Shanghai — Xintiandi Shikumen lighting ceremony and the Bund Source German Christmas Market.
- Same morning tour to the Great Wall at the Mutianyu section.
- Same New Year's Eve at Xi'an's Tang Dynasty Ever-Bright City.
- One day shorter than the Auckland departure (15 days vs 16) and NZ\$1,000 less per person.
- Return flights: CZ3533 Guangzhou–Shanghai · CZ3426 Chongqing–Guangzhou · CZ617 Guangzhou–Christchurch.

FULLY INCLUDED

- International and domestic airfares
- Accommodation (12 nights across 4 properties)
- Specified meals
- Private transfers and sightseeing transport
- English-speaking guides
- Entrance fees · 2nd-class train tickets

NOT INCLUDED

- China visa (if applicable)
- Travel insurance
- Personal expenses
- Guide and driver tips (suggested NZ\$10 pp/day)

Single supplement NZ\$968 · solo total NZ\$7,156

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/discovery/china-icons-collection-christchurch

Christmas & New Year — Christchurch

Christchurch · Guangzhou · Shanghai · Beijing · Xi'an · Chongqing



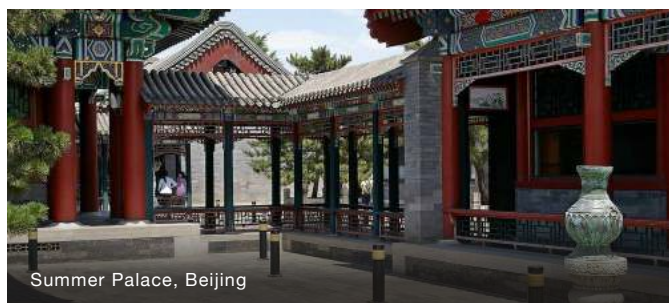
Yu Garden, Shanghai



The Bund, Shanghai



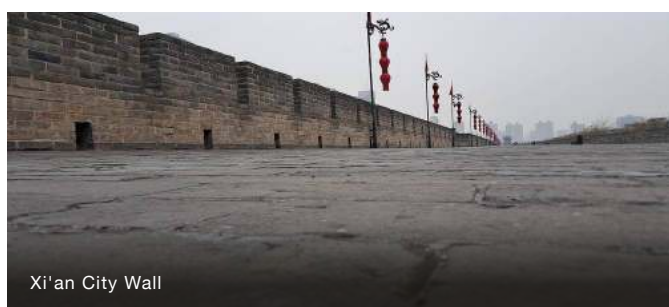
The Great Wall at Mutianyu



Summer Palace, Beijing



Hutong lanes, Beijing



Xi'an City Wall



Bell Tower, Xi'an



Ciqikou old town, Chongqing



Chongqing by night

DEPARTURE 04 · CHINA DISCOVERY

Best of China

15 days · Departs **Auckland 11 Mar 2027 & 13 May 2027** · Returns **25 Mar 2027 / 27 May 2027**

Beijing · Xi'an · Hangzhou · Tongxiang (Puyuan) · Shanghai

FROM

NZ\$4,080

per person, twin share

GROUP SIZE

Max 18

escorted from New Zealand

MEALS

22 included

12 B · 9 L · 1 D

HOTELS

12 nights

across 5 properties

HIGHLIGHTS ACROSS 15 DAYS

- 1 Temple of Heaven · Tian'anmen Square · Forbidden City · Beihai Park
- 2 Great Wall · jade carving factory · Olympic Park
- 3 Hutong pedi-cab tour with family visit · Silk Market
- 4 High-speed train G89 Beijing → Xi'an
- 5 Terracotta Warriors with Circle Vision Movie and Bronze Chariot
- 6 Xi'an City Wall · Big Wild Goose Pagoda · Small Wild Goose Pagoda Museum · Huimin Street
- 7 Puyuan Fashion Ancient Town, Tongxiang
- 8 West Lake boat tour · Leifeng Pagoda
- 9 G20 Hangzhou Expo Center · Longjing tea tasting · Qinghefang Ancient Street
- 10 Yu Garden · The Bund · Nanjing Road · Lujiazui skyline

FULLY INCLUDED

- International and domestic airfares
- Hotel accommodation (12 nights, 5 properties)
- English-speaking tour guide
- Entrance fees and specified meals
- Land transfers

NOT INCLUDED

- Travel insurance
- Personal expenses
- Unlisted meals · transport during free time
- Optional tours (acrobatic show, Tang Palace show)
- Tips (suggested NZ\$10 pp/day)

Single supplement NZ\$800 · solo total NZ\$4,880

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/discovery/essentials

Best of China

Beijing · Xi'an · Hangzhou · Tongxiang (Puyuan) · Shanghai



Temple of Heaven, Beijing



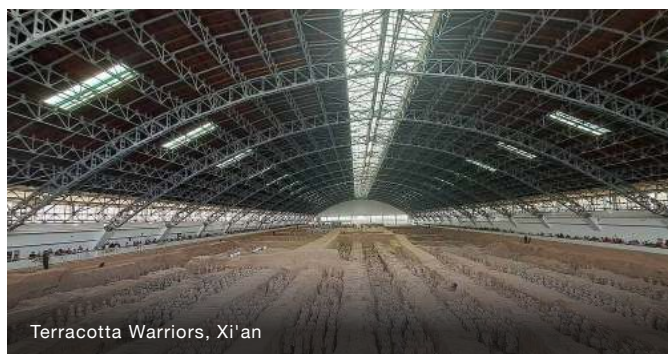
Forbidden City, Beijing



The Great Wall



Olympic Park, Beijing



Terracotta Warriors, Xi'an



Big Wild Goose Pagoda, Xi'an



West Lake, Hangzhou



Leifeng Pagoda, Hangzhou



Meijiawu Longjing tea plantation, Hangzhou



Lujiazui skyline, Shanghai

DEPARTURE 05 · CHINA DISCOVERY

A Tale of Two Cities

10 days · Departs **Auckland 18 Mar 2027** · Returns **27 Mar 2027**

Beijing · Xi'an

FROM

NZ\$3,480

per person, twin share

GROUP SIZE

Max 18

escorted from New Zealand

MEALS

12 included

7 B · 5 L

HOTELS

4★

7 nights

DAY BY DAY

- 1 Depart Auckland · flight to Beijing
- 2 Temple of Heaven · tea factory visit
- 3 Tian'anmen Square · Forbidden City · Beihai Park · silk factory
- 4 Great Wall · jade carving factory · Olympic Park (Bird's Nest, Water Cube)
- 5 Hutong pedi-cab tour with family visit · Silk Market
- 6 Free morning · high-speed train G89 to Xi'an (15:00–19:12)
- 7 Terracotta Warriors · Circle Vision Movie · Bronze Chariot exhibition
- 8 Xi'an City Wall · Big Wild Goose Pagoda
- 9 Small Wild Goose Pagoda Museum · Huimin Street (Muslim Quarter) · flight to Beijing
- 10 Return flight to Auckland

FULLY INCLUDED

- International and domestic airfares
- 4-star hotel accommodation (7 nights)
- English-speaking tour guide
- Entrance fees as specified
- 12 meals (7 breakfasts, 5 lunches)
- Land transfers

NOT INCLUDED

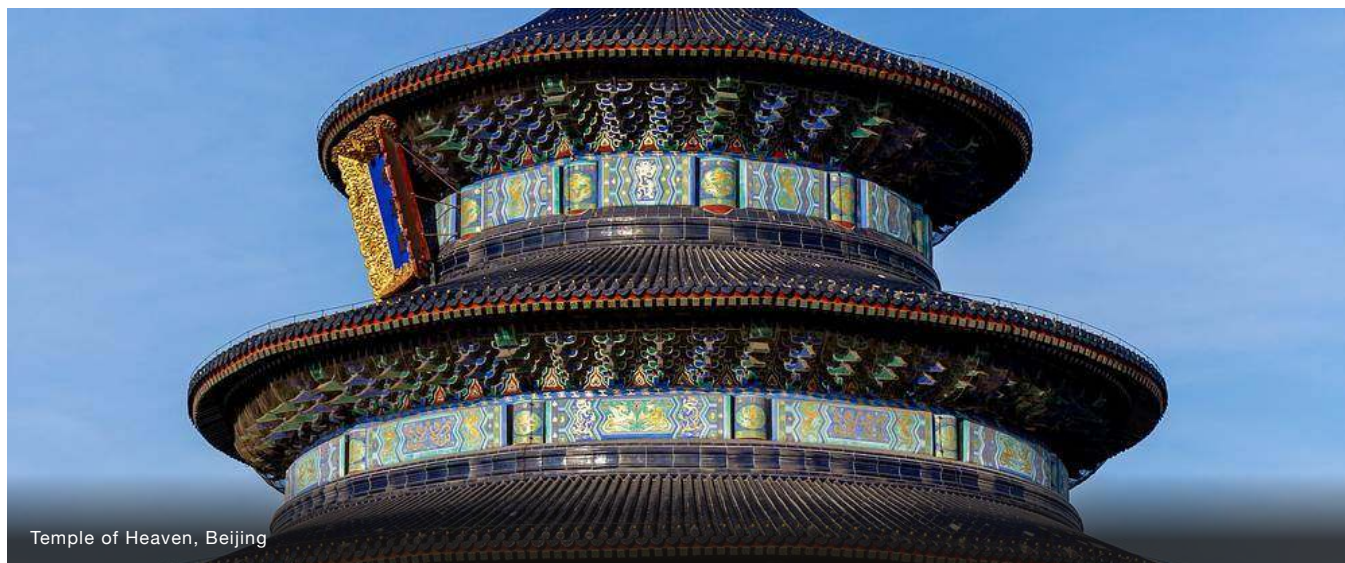
- Travel insurance
- Personal expenses
- Meals not listed
- Transport during free time
- Tips (suggested NZ\$10 pp/day)

Single supplement NZ\$395 for a private room — the smallest single supplement in this brochure

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/discovery/beijing-xian

A Tale of Two Cities

Beijing · Xi'an



Temple of Heaven, Beijing



Forbidden City, Beijing



The Great Wall



Olympic Park, Beijing



Hutong lanes, Beijing



Terracotta Warriors, Xi'an



Xi'an City Wall



Big Wild Goose Pagoda, Xi'an



Huimin Street, Xi'an

DEPARTURE 06 · CHINA DISCOVERY

Shanghai & Surroundings

10 days · Departs **Auckland 25 Mar 2027** · Returns **3 Apr 2027**

Shanghai · Suzhou · Wuxi · Xinshi Ancient Town · Hangzhou

FROM

NZ\$3,399

per person, twin share

GROUP SIZE

Max 18

escorted from New Zealand

MEALS

13 included

7 B · 5 L · 1 D

HOTELS

7 nights

hotel accommodation

DAY BY DAY

- 1 Auckland to Shanghai
- 2 Suzhou — Master of the Nets Garden · Panmen · Shantang Street
- 3 Wuxi — silk factory · Three Kingdoms City · Purple Sand Museum
- 4 Wuxi — Li Garden · Pearl Exhibition Centre · local market
- 5 Xinshi — Hanfu photos and afternoon tea
- 6 Hangzhou — West Lake · Su Causeway · Leifeng Pagoda
- 7 Hangzhou to Shanghai — G20 Expo Centre · Six Harmonies Pagoda · Longjing tea
- 8 Shanghai — The Bund · City God Temple · Art Exhibition Centre · Nanjing Road
- 9 Free time · optional Maglev trip · Shanghai departure
- 10 Arrive Auckland

FULLY INCLUDED

- International and domestic airfares
- 7 nights hotel accommodation
- English-speaking guide
- Entrance fees and specified meals
- Land transfers

NOT INCLUDED

- Travel insurance
- Personal expenses
- Meals not listed
- Optional activities (acrobatics, Maglev)
- Transport during free time
- Tips (suggested NZ\$10 pp/day)

Single supplement NZ\$400 · solo total NZ\$3,799 — the lowest tour price in this brochure

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/discovery/shanghai-surroundings

Shanghai & Surroundings

Shanghai · Suzhou · Wuxi · Xinshi Ancient Town · Hangzhou



The Bund, Shanghai



Nanjing Road, Shanghai



City God Temple quarter, Shanghai



Suzhou



West Lake and the Su Causeway, Hangzhou



Leifeng Pagoda, Hangzhou



Longjing tea, Hangzhou

DEPARTURE 07 · CHINA SIGNATURE

Natural China

16 days · Departs **Auckland 15 Mar 2027** · Returns **30 Mar 2027**

Shanghai · Guilin · Yangshuo · Chengdu · Leshan · Fenghuang · Zhangjiajie · Wulingyuan · Zhujiajiao

FROM

NZ\$8,150

per person, twin share

GROUP SIZE

Max 16

escorted from New Zealand

MEALS

29 included

13 B · 9 L · 7 D

HOTELS

4-5★

13 nights

WHERE THIS ONE GOES

- 1 Guilin and Yangshuo — the karst river country on the back of the 20-yuan note
- 2 Chengdu — giant pandas and the teahouse pace of Sichuan
- 3 Leshan — the Giant Buddha carved into the cliff at the river junction
- 4 Fenghuang Ancient Town — stilt houses over the Tuojiang River
- 5 Zhangjiajie and Wulingyuan — the sandstone pillar forest, a UNESCO World Heritage site
- 6 Zhujiajiao — the water town on Shanghai's outskirts
- 7 Travel between regions by domestic flights and First Class high-speed rail

FULLY INCLUDED

- Return international airfares from Auckland
- Domestic airfares within China
- 4-5 star hotel accommodation (13 nights)
- English-speaking tour guide
- Entrance fees and meals as specified
- Land transport including high-speed trains (First Class)

NOT INCLUDED

- Travel insurance
- Personal expenses
- Transport and guide services during free time
- Meals not listed in itinerary
- Tips (suggested NZ\$10 pp/day)

Single supplement NZ\$1,355 · maximum 16 travellers

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/signature/landscapes

Natural China

Shanghai · Guilin · Yangshuo · Chengdu · Leshan · Fenghuang · Zhangjiajie · Wulingyuan · Zhujiajiao



DEPARTURE 08 · CHINA SIGNATURE

China Panorama

27 days · Departs **Auckland 8 May 2027** · Returns **3 Jun 2027**

Beijing · Xi'an · Yichang · Chongqing · Chengdu · Dali · Kunming · Guilin · Yangshuo · Hangzhou · Suzhou · Shanghai

FROM

NZ\$10,899

per person, twin share

GROUP SIZE

Max 16

escorted from New Zealand

MEALS

50 included

23 B · 17 L · 10 D

HOTELS

4-5★24 nights + Victoria Yangtze
cruise

TWELVE CITIES IN ONE JOURNEY

- 1 Beijing — the Great Wall and the Forbidden City
- 2 Xi'an — the Terracotta Warriors
- 3 A four-day Yangtze River cruise through the Three Gorges aboard the 5-star Victoria fleet
- 4 Chengdu — giant pandas
- 5 Dali and Kunming — Yunnan's lake country and the Stone Forest
- 6 Guilin and a Li River cruise down to Yangshuo
- 7 Hangzhou — West Lake
- 8 Suzhou — the classical gardens
- 9 Shanghai — The Bund and the Huangpu River

FULLY INCLUDED

- Return international airfares from Auckland
- Domestic China airfares
- 4-5 star accommodation (24 nights)
- Victoria Yangtze River cruise (5-star)
- English-speaking guide
- Entrance fees and specified meals
- High-speed trains (First Class)

NOT INCLUDED

- Travel insurance
- Personal expenses
- Transport during free time
- Meals not listed
- Tips (suggested NZ\$10 pp/day)

Single supplement NZ\$2,555 · maximum 16 travellers · also departs 16 Oct 2027

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/signature/grand-tour

China Panorama

Beijing · Xi'an · Yichang · Chongqing · Chengdu · Dali · Kunming · Guilin · Yangshuo · Hangzhou · Suzhou · Shanghai



The Great Wall



Forbidden City, Beijing



Terracotta Warriors, Xi'an



The Three Gorges, Yangtze River



Aboard the Yangtze cruise



Summer Palace, Beijing



Giant pandas, Chengdu



Three Pagodas, Dali



Li River cruise to Yangshuo



West Lake, Hangzhou



Suzhou



Shanghai by night

DEPARTURE 09 · CHINA SIGNATURE

Silk Road

18 days · Departs **Auckland 13 May 2027** · Returns **30 May 2027**

Xi'an · Lanzhou · Wuwei · Zhangye · Jiayuguan · Dunhuang · Turpan · Urumqi

FROM

NZ\$7,999

per person, twin share

GROUP SIZE

Max 16

escorted from New Zealand

MEALS

38 included

15 B · 11 L · 12 D

HOTELS

4-5★

15 nights

THE ROUTE, WEST FROM XI'AN

- 1 Xi'an — the Terracotta Warriors, and the eastern end of the Silk Road
- 2 Lanzhou — the Bingling Temple grottoes
- 3 Wuwei and Zhangye — the Hexi Corridor
- 4 Jiayuguan — the western gate of the Great Wall
- 5 Dunhuang — two full days
- 6 Turpan — the desert oasis basin
- 7 Urumqi and Heavenly Lake
- 8 Return via Shanghai to New Zealand

FULLY INCLUDED

- International and domestic airfares
- 4-5 star hotel accommodation (15 nights)
- English-speaking tour guide
- Entrance fees and meals as specified in the itinerary
- Land transport

NOT INCLUDED

- China visa fee (if required)
- Travel insurance
- Personal expenses
- Transport and guide services during free time
- Meals not listed in itinerary
- Tips (suggested NZ\$10 pp/day)

Single supplement NZ\$1,488 · maximum 16 travellers · also departs 21 Oct 2027

ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/signature/silk-road

DEPARTURE 10 · CHINA SIGNATURE

Legacy of China

17 days · Departs **Auckland 28 May 2027** · Returns **13 Jun 2027**

Beijing · Xi'an · Lhasa · Chengdu · Chongqing · Shanghai

FROM

NZ\$9,999

per person, twin share

GROUP SIZE

Max 16

escorted from New Zealand

MEALS

31 included

14 B · 7 L · 10 D

HOTELS

5★

14 nights across 6 properties

HIGHLIGHTS ACROSS 17 DAYS

- 1 Beijing — Forbidden City · the Great Wall at Mutianyu · Temple of Heaven · Summer Palace
- 2 Xi'an — Terracotta Warriors · Muslim Quarter · dumpling banquet with Tang Dynasty dance · Ancient City Wall
- 3 **Lhasa — Jokhang Temple · Barkhor Street · Sera Monastery · Potala Palace · Norbulingka**
- 4 Chengdu — giant pandas
- 5 A three-night Yangtze River cruise through the Three Gorges
- 6 The Three Gorges Dam and Yichang
- 7 Shanghai — Yu Garden · silk factory · The Bund · Huangpu River night cruise

FULLY INCLUDED

- International and domestic airfares
- 5-star hotel accommodation (14 nights)
- English-speaking tour guide
- Entrance fees and specified meals
- Land transport including first-class high-speed trains

NOT INCLUDED

- Travel insurance
- Personal expenses
- Transport during free time
- Meals not listed in itinerary
- Tips (suggested NZ\$10 pp/day)

Single supplement NZ\$2,410 · maximum 16 travellers

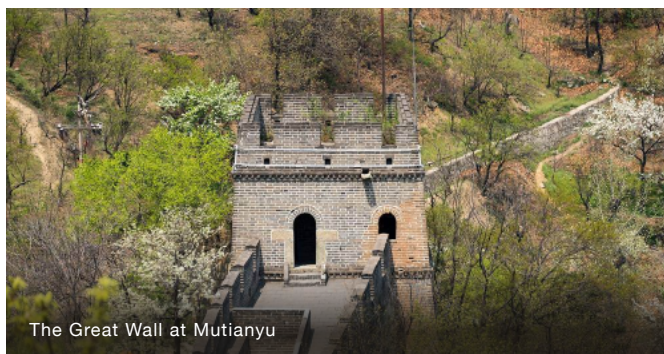
ctstours.co.nz/tours/china/signature/imperial-heritage

Legacy of China

Beijing · Xi'an · Lhasa · Chengdu · Chongqing · Shanghai



Forbidden City, Beijing



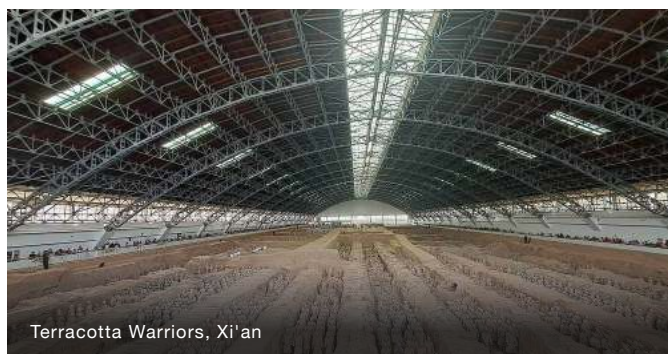
The Great Wall at Mutianyu



Temple of Heaven, Beijing



Summer Palace, Beijing



Terracotta Warriors, Xi'an



Muslim Quarter, Xi'an



Giant pandas, Chengdu



Yangtze River cruise



The Three Gorges



The Huangpu River by night, Shanghai

Six departures, side by side.

One decision helps most: are you going for late 2026, or the spring window in March 2027? Compare in one glance.

	Golden China 12 DAYS · NOV 2026	Christmas & New Year in China 16 DAYS · DEC 2026	Christmas & New Year — Christchurch 15 DAYS · DEC 2026	Best of China 15 DAYS · MAR & MAY 2027	A Tale of Two Cities 10 DAYS · MAR 2027	Shanghai & Surroundings 10 DAYS · MAR 2027
DEPARTS	Auckland 16 Nov 2026	Auckland 22 Dec 2026	Christchurch 22 Dec 2026	Auckland 11 Mar 2027 & 13 May 2027	Auckland 18 Mar 2027	Auckland 25 Mar 2027
RETURNS	27 Nov 2026	6 Jan 2027	5 Jan 2027	25 Mar 2027 / 27 May 2027	27 Mar 2027	3 Apr 2027
DURATION	12 days	16 days	15 days	15 days	10 days	10 days
CITIES	Beijing · Xi'an · Shanghai	Shanghai · Beijing · Xi'an · Chongqing · Guangzhou	Christchurch · Guangzhou · Shanghai · Beijing · Xi'an · Chongqing	Beijing · Xi'an · Hangzhou · Tongxiang (Puyuan) · Shanghai	Beijing · Xi'an	Shanghai · Suzhou · Wuxi · Xinshi Ancient Town · Hangzhou
MEALS	26 included 9 B · 7 L · 10 D	33 included 12 B · 9 L · 12 D	33 included 12 B · 9 L · 12 D	22 included 12 B · 9 L · 1 D	12 included 7 B · 5 L	13 included 7 B · 5 L · 1 D
HOTELS	4★ · 9 nights across 3 properties	4★ · 13 nights across 5 properties	4★ · 12 nights across 4 properties	12 nights · across 5 properties	4★ · 7 nights	7 nights · hotel accommodation
GROUP SIZE	Max 18	Max 18	Max 18	Max 18	Max 18	Max 18
FROM PRICE	NZ\$4,999pp	NZ\$7,188pp	NZ\$6,188pp	NZ\$4,080pp	NZ\$3,480pp	NZ\$3,399pp
SINGLE SUPP.	NZ\$690	NZ\$968	NZ\$968	NZ\$800	NZ\$395	NZ\$400

Best of China runs twice in 2027 — 11 March and 13 May — at the same price, so the March column covers both. All prices are per person, twin share, in New Zealand dollars, and were checked against ctstours.co.nz on 22 September 2026.



Longer journeys, side by **side**.

Four China Signature departures in 2027, all capped at 16 travellers, all with first-class rail between regions.

	Natural China 16 DAYS · MAR 2027	China Panorama 27 DAYS · MAY 2027	Silk Road 18 DAYS · MAY 2027	Legacy of China 17 DAYS · MAY 2027
DEPARTS	Auckland 15 Mar 2027	Auckland 8 May 2027	Auckland 13 May 2027	Auckland 28 May 2027
RETURNS	30 Mar 2027	3 Jun 2027	30 May 2027	13 Jun 2027
DURATION	16 days	27 days	18 days	17 days
CITIES	Shanghai · Guilin · Yangshuo · Chengdu · Leshan · Fenghuang · Zhangjiajie · Wulingyuan · Zhujiajiao	Beijing · Xi'an · Yichang · Chongqing · Chengdu · Dali · Kunming · Guilin · Yangshuo · Hangzhou · Suzhou · Shanghai	Xi'an · Lanzhou · Wuwei · Zhangye · Jiayuguan · Dunhuang · Turpan · Urumqi	Beijing · Xi'an · Lhasa · Chengdu · Chongqing · Shanghai
MEALS	29 included 13 B · 9 L · 7 D	50 included 23 B · 17 L · 10 D	38 included 15 B · 11 L · 12 D	31 included 14 B · 7 L · 10 D
HOTELS	4–5★ · 13 nights	4–5★ · 24 nights + Victoria Yangtze cruise	4–5★ · 15 nights	5★ · 14 nights across 6 properties
GROUP SIZE	Max 16	Max 16	Max 16	Max 16
FROM PRICE	NZ\$8,150pp	NZ\$10,899pp	NZ\$7,999pp	NZ\$9,999pp
SINGLE SUPP.	NZ\$1,355	NZ\$2,555	NZ\$1,488	NZ\$2,410

Not sure which one?

Reply to any CTS email or call the Auckland office, and Baker or the team will walk you through it. We'll ask about timing, group preferences, and any dietary or mobility considerations — then match you to the right departure. **0800 CTS 888 · info@ctstours.co.nz**

CHINA STOPOVER

Turn the transit into the trip.

Flying to Europe, Japan or Korea? Break the journey for two to five days in one Chinese city — hotel, guide, transfers and admissions arranged, so you step off the plane and straight into it.

2 days	Shanghai Express	NZ\$875
3 days	Xi'an	NZ\$945
3 days	Shanghai	NZ\$1,060
3 days	Guilin	NZ\$1,099
3 days	Shanghai & Suzhou	NZ\$1,356
3 days	Chengdu	NZ\$1,359
3 days	Guangzhou	NZ\$1,399
3 days	Beijing Express	NZ\$1,450
3 days	Zhangjiajie	NZ\$1,899
4 days	Guilin & Surrounds	NZ\$1,310
4 days	Huangshan	NZ\$1,635
4 days	Shanghai & Wuzhen	NZ\$1,760
4 days	Guangzhou & Shenzhen	NZ\$2,340
5 days	Beijing	NZ\$2,120

TYPICALLY INCLUDED

- 4-star hotel accommodation, twin share
- Meals as specified in the itinerary
- English-speaking guide
- Land transfers
- Admission to scheduled attractions

Are flights included?

“Do not assume they are. Check the Included and Not Included sections on the individual tour page. International airfare, through-ticketing and connection changes are confirmed separately unless a product explicitly states otherwise.”

In plain terms: most stopover routes are a land package and the international airfare is arranged separately. Check the Included and Not Included list on the route you want, or ask us and we'll price the flights with it.



TAILOR-MADE CHINA

A journey designed around you

Your dates. Your pace. Your interests.

Tailor-made China. Your kind of journey. If none of the eleven departures in this brochure is quite your trip — different dates, a slower pace, a family group, a city we haven't listed — we build it from scratch with you.

HOW IT WORKS

1

Tell us your ideas

A few details are enough to begin. Tell us what matters most to you.

2

Shape it together

Your specialist helps refine the route, pace, hotels and budget.

3

Confirm your journey

Review your proposal, inclusions and availability before booking.

**No obligation. A
real specialist,
from the first
conversation.**

Start planning at
ctstours.co.nz/tailor-made or call
0800 CTS 888. You talk to a China
specialist, not a form.

RECENT TAILOR-MADE TRIPS

Family groups, 25-day private itineraries, Yunnan and Zhangjiajie combinations, and shorter trips built around a business visit. Ask us what is possible on your dates.

Your shopping time is yours.

No compulsory shopping stops — your shopping time is yours. If you have travelled to China on a cheap group tour before, you will know the pattern: three hours you did not ask for in a jade showroom. That is not how CTS builds an itinerary.

WHERE OUR ITINERARIES ACTUALLY PUT YOU

- **Shanghai** — Nanjing Road and the Yu Garden bazaar sit in the itinerary on Golden China and Best of China, and the following day on Golden China is Shanghai at your own pace.
- **Xi'an** — Huimin Street and the Muslim Quarter night market, on both Christmas departures, Best of China and A Tale of Two Cities.
- **Beijing** — the Silk Market, after the hutong pedi-cab tour on Best of China and A Tale of Two Cities.
- **Chongqing** — Ciqikou old town, on both Christmas departures.
- **Guangzhou** — free shopping time before the transfer to the airport on the Auckland Christmas departure.

Where an itinerary does include a silk, jade or pearl workshop — and several do — it is named in the day-by-day schedule on ctstours.co.nz, so you can read it before you book rather than discover it on the coach.



Five things Kiwis get **wrong**.

China moves fast, especially in the cities. A few things to sort before you fly.

01 **Mobile payment is the default.**

Download Alipay or WeChat Pay before you fly — both now support international NZ-issued cards. In the big cities almost every transaction is a QR code. Rural areas and smaller shops still prefer cash, so carry some RMB too.

02 **Google won't work. Baidu will.**

Google Maps is unreliable inside China. Use Baidu Maps or Gaode Maps for navigation. For menu translation, download Pleco — it works fully offline and reads menus through the camera.

03 **Set up a VPN before you leave.**

Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp, YouTube and Gmail all face restrictions. Install and test a VPN on your phone before you leave New Zealand — or embrace the digital break.

04 **Basic Mandarin goes a long way.**

Nǐ hǎo (hello), xièxie (thank you) and duōshǎo qián (how much) is 90% of the effort. Locals genuinely appreciate the try, and it turns transactions into small conversations.

05 **Tell your bank you're going.**

New Zealand card fraud systems can block a first Chinese ATM withdrawal automatically. A quick call to your bank ahead of time avoids getting locked out on day one.

ONE THING YOU DO NOT NEED TO SORT

Your CTS guide handles tickets, queues, transfers and the language at every stop on the itinerary. These five are simply the things that sit outside a guide's reach — your phone, your bank and your own free afternoons.

Straight through the gate.

30

Days visa-free for NZ passport holders

Valid through 31 December 2026. Tourism, business, family, transit. Unlimited entries. No application forms. **For 2027 departures, entry requirements will be whatever policy applies at the time you travel — we confirm this with you before departure and assist with a visa if one is needed.**

WHAT TO BRING AT IMMIGRATION

- NZ passport with blank pages for stamps
- Return flight dated within the permitted stay
- Proof of accommodation — your CTS tour confirmation is enough
- Sufficient funds (credit cards plus some cash)

WHEN YOU STILL NEED A VISA

- Working in China → Z-Visa
- Study or internship → X-Visa
- Staying longer than the visa-free allowance → L-Visa
- Long-term residence → consult the Embassy

HOW TO BOOK

Deposit NZ\$500pp to hold

Reply to any CTS email and Baker or the team will confirm availability, walk you through the small print, and hold your room. Amendments to dates or travellers are free up to 60 days before departure.

YOUR MONEY IS PROTECTED

CTS Tours is a TAANZ member and all client funds sit in a **TAANZ-bonded trust account**. Card payments are processed through PCI-DSS compliant gateways.

TALK IT THROUGH

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175 Queen Street, Auckland CBD

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Prices, dates and inclusions in this brochure were checked against ctstours.co.nz on 22 September 2026 and are per person in New Zealand dollars, twin share, subject to availability. Google rating 4.4★ from 12 verified reviews, checked 22 September 2026.

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